from England so cruel as at this moment, when I might have been near to comfort and soothe you. Gods will be done, it is no doubt wrong perhaps even wicked to grieve and repine, but surely the loss of such a mother as mine may excuse a son's tears. I have no letter from you and therefore I do not know whether George was in England at the time or not. I trust he was. T. Foljambe's letter is most kind, he says you had written to me. I suppose the letter has been detained some where or miscarried.

My griefs do not prevent my attending to the business which brought me here, and my arrival was just in time to prevent some disturbances and perhaps bloodshed in the town of Binaub which the villages adjoin. In the villages under my charge all, thank God, was quiet. The people had heard of the Princes abrupt departure from Tabreez, (mentioned in my letter to you on the 5*th* or 6*th* of this month) with many exagerations, such as that he had been sent for as a state criminal, had run the country, etc. and they were about despatching a messenger to see what had become of me.

I believe all will go well with the Prince and it is very probable that he may be reinstated in his govt.[115] The accounts he had heard of the slanders against him were much exagerated and I believe our government will support him. Few Persian Princes have been so truly the poor man's friend as Bahman Meerza, and amongst the lower and middle classes his departure is universally deplored. The country, generally, is much more quiet than I had expected. The town of Tabreez on the contrary is in confusion. A few days ago the head of police was attacked, murdered, and many of his people wounded in broad-day, by a band of ruffians who after the deed marched through the town, the provisional governor not having courage enough to seize them.

[Edward Burgess to George Burgess] *Tabreez, April 4, 1848*

I know you will be anxious to know how the world is going with me, in these troublous times, at least they are so for my master Bahman Meerza, and for a great many people in Persia. I still remain in my former position attached to the young Prince's Bahman Meerza's sons, and altho like all who stand by a fallen house, I am sufficiently ill off, I should not like to leave them, I have much affection both for them and their father, and altho I have as yet got no pay since last September, I think it would be wrong to leave them. I am no worse off than the greater part of his followers, and I believe I shall get my pay in a day or two, at least the greater part of the arrears, and I have also some hopes that if I remain in my present position, arrangements will be made to enable me to get my salary regularly. Nothing of importance has taken place since Bahman

[115] He was exiled to Russia by his brother, Mohammed Shah.

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